Mapping the meta

Prototype for review; outside runtime discovery.

The aim is to explain the environment a player is operating in. A useful map shows which strategies occupy similar territory, what separates them, and where the evidence leaves room for alternatives. Rankings are observations to explain, not the finished analysis.

Establish the landscape

Start with the user's scope and the available data population. Establish what period the evidence describes before making claims about the current meta. If only one snapshot is available, describe its structure without inventing a trend or implying that a strategy has recently emerged.

Take an initial view broad enough to reveal major patterns in both popularity and outcomes. Use it to form questions: Are several apparent leaders variants of one strategy? Do different lines rely on the same units? Is a rare result a distinct option or an unusually expensive version of a common board?

Let those questions determine the next cuts. Do not automatically expand every unit, trait, item, and composition into a separate report.

Find the organizing patterns

Group strategies by properties the evidence actually supports: shared core units, item allocations, trait structures, achieved investment, or documented mechanical requirements. A trait label alone may conceal several strategies; different labels may describe substantially the same core.

Distinguish the pieces that define a strategy from pieces that happen to appear on its strongest observed boards. Compare variants when that distinction would change the map. Preserve uncertainty when the data cannot separate a core requirement from a frequent addition.

Look for dependencies across strategies. Shared holders, units, and item needs can explain why nominally different options offer less flexibility than they appear to. Describe shared demand as a potential pressure; observed pick rates alone do not establish actual contesting in a particular lobby.

Examine exceptions

Investigate an exception when it challenges the emerging explanation. A popular weak performer, a rare strong result, or a successful variant missing a supposed core piece may reveal a useful boundary. It may also reflect selection or sparse support. Compare the relevant populations before giving the exception a story.

Do not turn achieved final levels or expensive completed boards into proof that the meta rewards a particular leveling schedule. Strategy access, tempo, and transition difficulty require evidence beyond the final state.

Write the map

Organize the answer around a few supported themes and the strategies that illustrate them. Explain what distinguishes the alternatives and which apparent differences are superficial. Include the evidence and limitations that could change those conclusions, without reproducing every exploratory query.

The result should let the reader place an unfamiliar line in context. Stop when the major relationships are explained and remaining queries would add entries without changing the picture. An incomplete but well-supported map is preferable to a comprehensive hierarchy built from guesses.